# Shipping Charges – How We Stop Losing Money

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## 1. The problem in one line

Our website charges shipping by the product's **weight**, but Shiprocket charges by the **size of the box** as well. For light but big items (lamps, planters, figurines) the box is what costs money – so we under-charge the customer and pay the difference.

**Real example – Order #BMJ1004 (lamp to Mumbai):**

| | Amount |
|---|---|
| Lamp actual weight | 0.675 kg |
| Box size used | ≈ 8.9 kg "volumetric" weight |
| Customer paid for shipping | ₹160 |
| Shiprocket charged us | ₹451 |
| **Loss on this one order** | **≈ ₹290** |

## 2. How couriers actually charge

Every courier calculates two weights and charges the **higher** one:

| Weight | How it is calculated |
|---|---|
| Dead weight | What the packed box weighs on a scale |
| Volumetric weight | Length × Breadth × Height (cm) ÷ 5000 |
| **Chargeable weight** | **Whichever of the two is higher** |

Example: a 26 × 26 × 28.5 cm box = 3.85 kg volumetric, even if the lamp inside weighs only 0.33 kg. If we enter a smaller size than the real box, the courier re-measures at the hub and deducts the difference from our Shiprocket wallet.

## 3. Our plan – two simple changes

| Step | What we do | Why |
|---|---|---|
| A. Box weight on website | For each product, set its Shopify weight = the chargeable weight of the box it ships in (not its bare weight). | So the website knows the "real" shipping weight and picks the right price slab. |
| B. New price slabs | Update the shipping charges per weight band to match real Shiprocket costs (table in section 5). | So what the customer pays covers what we pay. |

Small items (jewellery, pouches, stoles, coasters) hardly change. Only bulky items move to a higher slab.

## 4. What we tested

**a) Real Shiprocket rates** – 14 products, from our pickup (Kolkata 700029) to Mumbai and Kolkata, using a fitted box (product size + 5 cm padding on each side).

| Product | Chargeable wt | Kolkata (cheapest) | Mumbai – Blue Dart | Mumbai – Ekart* |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Tikuli pen stand | 0.56 kg | ₹84 | ₹156 | – |

| Product | Chargeable wt | Kolkata (cheapest) | Mumbai – Blue Dart | Mumbai – Ekart* |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Maa Kali figurine | 1.6 kg | ₹87 | ₹309 | ₹309 |
| Black Tikuli tray | 2.3 kg | ₹124 | ₹386 | ₹309 |
| Red Jamdani lamp | 3.85 kg | ₹161 | ₹616 | ₹309 |
| Tagore clay sculpture | 4.3 kg | ₹197 | ₹692 | ₹309 |
| Lord Shiv & Maa Durga | 6.9 kg | ₹264 | ₹1,076 | ₹309 |
| Big Giraffe planter | 10.1 kg | ₹289 | – | ₹415 |
| Ek Chaala Maa Durga | 15.6 kg | ₹418 | – | ₹597 |

* Ekart's service to Mumbai starts at 7 kg and costs a flat ₹309 up to that level. Any parcel from about 1.5 kg up can be booked as 7 kg on Ekart – booking a **higher** weight is allowed; only under-declaring is penalised.

**b) Website checkout test** – we set up the new slabs on 3 products in a temporary test, checked checkout (stopped before payment), then removed the test. **All 8 checks matched.**

| Product (test weight) | Mumbai | Kolkata |
|---|---|---|
| Pen stand (0.56 kg) | ₹160 ✓ | ₹130 ✓ |
| Red Jamdani lamp (3.85 kg) | ₹330 ✓ | ₹280 ✓ |
| Big Giraffe planter (10.1 kg) | ₹450 ✓ | ₹420 ✓ |
| Pen stand + lamp together (4.4 kg) | ₹330 ✓ | ₹280 ✓ |

## 5. Proposed shipping charges (for your approval)

**"Order weight" here = chargeable weight** – the higher of dead weight and volumetric weight of each product's box, added up for all items in the cart. Shopify does this automatically once each product's weight is set to its chargeable weight (step A).

| Order weight (chargeable) | West Bengal | Rest of India | North-East & J&K |
|---|---|---|---|
| 0 – 0.5 kg | ₹90 | ₹95 | ₹130 |
| 0.5 – 1 kg | ₹130 | ₹160 | ₹180 |
| 1 – 2 kg | ₹160 | ₹330 | ₹400 |
| 2 – 7 kg | ₹280 | ₹330 | ₹400 |
| 7 – 12 kg | ₹420 | ₹450 | ₹540 |
| 12 – 20 kg | ₹420 | ₹650 | ₹780 |

Changes from today are only for orders above 1 kg. West Bengal stays almost the same (we already cover cost there). North-East is estimated ~20% above Rest of India and still needs one rate check.

## Which weight goes where – quick reference

| Where | Which weight to enter | Example (Red Jamdani lamp) |
|---|---|---|
| Shopify → product → Weight | **Chargeable** = higher of dead vs volumetric of its box | 3.85 kg |
| Shiprocket → order → Weight | **Dead weight** – packed box on the scale (or 7 kg when booking Ekart, see section 6) | 0.8 kg actual, or 7 kg for Ekart |
| Shiprocket → order → L × B × H | **Real box size** in cm – Shiprocket calculates volumetric itself | 26 × 26 × 28.5 |

| Where | Which weight to enter | Example (Red Jamdani lamp) |
|---|---|---|
| Section 5 slabs | **Chargeable** (total of cart) | 3.85 kg → ₹330 (Rest of India) |
| Section 6 courier table | **Chargeable** – the "Applicable weight" Shiprocket shows | 3.85 kg → book as 7 kg on Ekart |

## 6. Which courier to choose – important

Courier prices differ a lot for bulky parcels (4 kg box to Mumbai: Ekart ₹309 · DTDC ₹403 · Blue Dart ₹692). The website charges above assume we pick the **cheapest** option:

| Parcel – Applicable (chargeable) weight in Shiprocket | Enter as dead weight | Courier |
|---|---|---|
| Up to 1.5 kg | Actual (scale) weight | Cheapest shown (often Blue Dart / Amazon) |
| 1.5 – 7 kg | 7 kg | Ekart 5Kg (~₹309) or DTDC |
| Above 7 kg | Actual (scale) weight | Ekart / DTDC 10 kg |

In Shiprocket always: (1) enter the real box size and weight, (2) set **Dangerous goods = No** (the lamp was wrongly flagged – that is why only one courier appeared), (3) sort by **price low to high**. Use Blue Dart for big parcels only if the customer needs speed.

## 7. Packing rules for the team

• Use the smallest box that fits safely – every extra cm costs money.

• Weigh and measure the packed box; take a photo of it on the scale (proof if Shiprocket raises a weight dispute).

• Enter the real L × B × H and weight in Shiprocket – never less.

• Fold textiles flat; take lamps apart where possible.

• Paintings without frame: ship rolled in a tube (much cheaper than a box).

## 8. What we need from you

| # | Decision / input |
|---|---|
| 1 | Approve the new shipping charges in section 5 (or tell us your preferred numbers). |
| 2 | OK to always pick the cheapest courier for bulky parcels (Ekart / DTDC)? |
| 3 | Packed box size for lamps and other bulky items (or approve our suggested fitted sizes). |
| 4 | Any items you would rather absorb shipping on (add part of it to the product price instead)? |

Once approved, we update the rates and the shipping weights of bulky products, test checkout again, and confirm.